

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 1496

By Carringer

A RESOLUTION to honor and congratulate J.P. Payne of Knoxville Central High School on being named District 3, Class 4A Coach of the Year in boys' basketball.

WHEREAS, this General Assembly takes great pleasure in recognizing those Tennesseans who have distinguished themselves as great athletic coaches while motivating the young men and women under their charge to reach for and attain the greatest heights; and

WHEREAS, J.P. Payne, first-year boys' basketball coach at Knoxville Central High School, is most assuredly one such outstanding mentor; he quickly reversed the Bobcats' fortunes during the 2025-2026 season and led his team to 28 victories, the most wins in a single season in school history; and

WHEREAS, after Knoxville Central suffered through a losing season in 2024-2025, J.P. Payne was hired as the Bobcats' new leader, and he quickly engineered a turnaround that resulted in his team posting a perfect 10-0 record to claim the District 3, Class 4A regular season championship for 2025-2026; and

WHEREAS, Coach Payne and the Bobcats then vanquished Knoxville Halls and Knoxville West to win the District 3, Class 4A tournament title and advance to the regionals; and

WHEREAS, Coach Payne's inspiring leadership of the Knoxville Central Bobcats was appropriately honored by his recognition as 2025-2026 District 3, Class 4A Coach of the Year in boys' basketball; and

WHEREAS, Coach Payne has become a powerful force in only one year, and he is most worthy of our approbation on this special occasion; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE

CONCURRING, that we honor and congratulate J.P. Payne on being named District 3, Class 4A Coach of the Year in boys' basketball and extend to him our best wishes for much continued success on the court and in life.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.